

Change Apps Included for Search, Share and Notification

As you use Windows 8 for a long time, and install a growing number of application, you might find that the search and share integrations that Windows provides start to become overwhelming. Each time you search you will find a list of dozens of applications that provide that feature, when you use it for only a few of them.

Think about it, how often do you think you search the Travel or Weather apps, if you even have them installed. Likewise you might find that you simply aren't sharing content using many of the apps that support the feature.

You might also find that you are getting far too many notifications for the feature to be useful.

Windows 8 makes turning off individual apps from search, share and notifications quite simple. The first thing you need to do is launch the Modern UI version of the control panel:

- ▶ Open the settings charm (Win+I).
- ▶ Click on "Change PC settings" right at the bottom.

Here you will find a page for Notifications, Search and Share. Each page will list the applications that can use that feature with each application having an option to turn it off.

Use File History for Backup

You read about the prerequisites of this feature in Chapter 4, now we show you how to use it as a back up. You know File History automatically back sup all your Libraries. Remember that you can add existing folders from anywhere on your hard drive to a library, Given that, simply create a library called backup and use it just for including folders to back up.

Use File History With a Single Drive

If you are in the situation where you don't have another hard drive, network drive, or portable drive to back up to, but would still like to use File History just so you can access previous versions of files, here is a trick you can use.

What you can do is fake the presence of an additional hard drive by using a virtual hard drive file. To do this you can use take advantage of the fact that Windows supports virtual hard drives natively. Read the tip about using virtual hard drives, and then use such a virtual hard drive as the destination for the backup.